

Kautilya's Arthashastra

BORI Lecture Series — Dr. Manish Rajan Walvekar

100 Multiple Choice Questions

Q1. What are the three near synonyms of Arthashastra in ancient Sanskrit literature?

- A) Arthashastra, Dandaniti, and Rajashastra
- B) Arthashastra, Dharmashastra, and Kamashastra
- C) Dandaniti, Nitishastra, and Dharmashastra
- D) Arthashastra, Manusmriti, and Yajnavalkyasmriti

Answer: A — The text identifies Arthashastra, Dandaniti, and Rajashastra (also called Rajaniti or Nitishastra) as near synonyms.

Q2. According to Kautilya (15.1-2), what is Arthashastra?

- A) The science of righteous living
- B) The science to obtain and protect the land inhabited by human beings
- C) The science of warfare and diplomacy
- D) The science of religious ceremonies

Answer: B — Kautilya defines Arthashastra as the science for acquiring and protecting the land that is the source of human livelihood.

Q3. What are the three names by which the author of the Arthashastra is known?

- A) Bhrigu, Brihaspati, and Shukra
- B) Manu, Yajnavalkya, and Parasara
- C) Vishnugupta, Kautilya, and Chanakya
- D) Vatsyayana, Bharadvaja, and Pishuna

Answer: C — Vishnugupta, Kautilya, and Chanakya are three names for the same person, the author of the Arthashastra.

Q4. How many Adhikaranas does the Arthashastra contain?

- A) 10
- B) 12
- C) 15
- D) 18

Answer: C — The Arthashastra is structured into 15 Adhikaranas (books).

Q5. How many Adhyayas (chapters) are in the Arthashastra?

- A) 100
- B) 120
- C) 150
- D) 180

Answer: C — The text has 150 Adhyayas.

Q6. The Arthashastra is said to be an Upaveda of which Veda?

- A) Rigveda
- B) Yajurveda

- C) Samaveda
- D) Atharvaveda

Answer: D — The Arthashastra is identified as an Upaveda of the Atharvaveda.

Q7. What are the two branches of administration distinguished by Kautilya?

- A) Military and Civilian
- B) Janapada (rural) and Durga (urban)
- C) Religious and Secular
- D) Royal and Common

Answer: B — Kautilya divides administration into Janapada (rural) and Durga (capital/urban).

Q8. How many shlokas does the Arthashastra approximately contain?

- A) 3000
- B) 4000
- C) 6000
- D) 8000

Answer: C — The Arthashastra contains approximately 6000 shlokas.

Q9. Books 1 to 5 of the Arthashastra deal with which category?

- A) Aavapa (foreign relations)
- B) Tantra (internal administration)
- C) Military science
- D) Secret practices

Answer: B — Books 1-5 deal with tantra or internal administration.

Q10. What is the foremost duty of the king according to Kautilya?

- A) Expansion of territory
- B) Collection of taxes
- C) The happiness of the subjects
- D) Maintenance of the army

Answer: C — The Prajasukhe verse states that in the happiness of the subjects lies the happiness of the king.

Q11. How many great calamities must the king protect against according to Arthashastra 5.3.1-2?

- A) Four
- B) Six
- C) Eight
- D) Ten

Answer: C — The king must protect against eight great calamities: fire, floods, diseases, famine, rats, wild elephants, serpents, and evil spirits.

Q12. What are the four Vidyas (sciences) listed in Arthashastra 1.2.1?

- A) Dharma, Artha, Kama, Moksha
- B) Anvikshiki, Trayi, Vartta, Dandaniti
- C) Sankhya, Yoga, Vedanta, Mimamsa

D) Rigveda, Yajurveda, Samaveda, Atharvaveda

Answer: B — The four sciences are Anvikshiki (philosophy), Trayi (three Vedas), Vartta (economics), and Dandaniti (governance).

Q13. What three systems of thought are included within Anvikshiki?

- A) Vedanta, Mimamsa, Nyaya
- B) Sankhya, Yoga, Lokayata
- C) Buddhism, Jainism, Charvaka
- D) Vaisheshika, Samkhya, Vedanta

Answer: B — Anvikshiki includes Sankhya, Yoga, and Lokayata.

Q14. What is Matsyanyaya (the law of the fish)?

- A) A rule about fishing rights
- B) Chaos where the strong prey on the weak in the absence of authority
- C) A tax levied on fishermen
- D) A diplomatic strategy

Answer: B — Matsyanyaya describes the chaos without governing authority where the strong prey on the weak.

Q15. What are the six internal enemies of a king?

- A) Poverty, disease, famine, flood, fire, drought
- B) Lust, anger, greed, pride, arrogance, recklessness
- C) Enemy kings, spies, traitors, rebels, criminals, invaders
- D) Ministers, princes, queens, generals, priests, allies

Answer: B — The six internal enemies are lust, anger, greed, pride, arrogance, and recklessness.

Q16. Until what age does the prince observe celibacy?

- A) Twelve
- B) Fourteen
- C) Sixteen
- D) Eighteen

Answer: C — The prince observes celibacy until age sixteen, after which he undergoes a ceremony and enters marriage.

Q17. What are the four secret tests (Upadha) used to evaluate ministers?

- A) Test of knowledge, wealth, courage, loyalty
- B) Test of piety, material gain, lust, fear
- C) Test of strength, wisdom, honesty, devotion
- D) Test of speech, action, thought, endurance

Answer: B — The four secret tests are of piety, material gain, lust, and fear.

Q18. Ministers who pass the test of piety are assigned to which function?

- A) Military command
- B) Treasury management
- C) Judicial functions
- D) Intelligence operations

Answer: C — Those passing the test of piety are given judicial functions.

Q19. What are the two broad classes of spies?

- A) Military and civilian
- B) Sthayi (stationary) and Sanchari (roving)
- C) Internal and external
- D) Royal and common

Answer: B — Spies are organised into Sthayi (stationary) and Sanchari (roving) classes.

Q20. Under what condition is a spy's report considered credible?

- A) When confirmed by the king personally
- B) When two spies agree
- C) When three independent spies corroborate it
- D) When supported by documentary evidence

Answer: C — A report is credible only when three independent spies corroborate it.

Q21. What are the four groups in an enemy's territory that can be turned against the enemy?

- A) Soldiers, merchants, priests, farmers
- B) The Enraged, the Frightened, the Greedy, the Proud
- C) Women, children, elders, slaves
- D) Ministers, generals, princes, ambassadors

Answer: B — The four groups are the Enraged, the Frightened, the Greedy, and the Proud.

Q22. What are the three grades of envoy?

- A) Royal, ministerial, common
- B) Nisrishtartha, Parimitartha, Shasanahara
- C) Military, diplomatic, commercial
- D) Senior, middle, junior

Answer: B — The three grades are Nisrishtartha (plenipotentiary), Parimitartha (limited mission), and Shasanahara (message bearer).

Q23. Into how many parts does Kautilya divide the king's day?

- A) Four
- B) Six
- C) Eight
- D) Twelve

Answer: C — Both the day and the night are divided into eight parts each.

Q24. How many families should a village ideally contain according to Kautilya?

- A) 50 to 100
- B) 100 to 500
- C) 500 to 1000
- D) 1000 to 5000

Answer: B — Villages are established with 100 to 500 families, with marked boundaries, for mutual protection.

Q25. Where is the royal palace constructed in the fortified city?

- A) In the centre
- B) In the southern part, facing west
- C) In the northern part, facing east or north
- D) In the eastern part, facing south

Answer: C — The royal palace is in the northern part of the city, facing east or north.

Q26. What facilities does the Director of Stores build?

- A) Schools, hospitals, temples
- B) Treasury, warehouse, magazine, armoury, prisons
- C) Roads, bridges, canals
- D) Markets, factories, workshops

Answer: B — The Director of Stores builds treasury, warehouse, magazine, armoury, and secure prisons.

Q27. What is the colour description of the best quality gold?

- A) Deep red like rubies
- B) Bright white like silver
- C) Pale yellow like lotus filaments
- D) Dark brown like honey

Answer: C — The best gold is described as pale yellow like lotus filaments.

Q28. What tax rate applies to flowers, fruits, and vegetables?

- A) One tenth
- B) One sixth
- C) One fifth
- D) One twentieth

Answer: B — Flowers, fruits, and vegetables are taxed at one sixth.

Q29. What is the fee for a sealed passport?

- A) One pana
- B) One mashaka
- C) Twelve panas
- D) Six panas

Answer: B — A sealed pass is issued for a fee of one mashaka.

Q30. How many ministerial judges handle frontier post cases?

- A) One
- B) Two
- C) Three
- D) Five

Answer: C — Three ministerial judges handle cases arising from frontier post transactions.

Q31. What is the maintenance limit on a woman's property?

- A) One thousand panas
- B) Two thousand panas

- C) Five thousand panas
- D) No limit

Answer: B — Maintenance is capped at two thousand panas, while there is no limit on ornaments.

Q32. What is the legal age of majority for a man?

- A) Twelve
- B) Fourteen
- C) Sixteen
- D) Eighteen

Answer: C — The age of legal majority is sixteen for a man.

Q33. Who inherits property that has no heirs?

- A) The priest
- B) The village
- C) The king
- D) The temple

Answer: C — The king inherits property without heirs, excluding certain essential needs.

Q34. Who has priority to purchase immovable property?

- A) The king, then ministers
- B) Anyone who offers the highest price
- C) Kinsmen, neighbours, creditors (in that order)
- D) Religious institutions first

Answer: C — Priority goes to kinsmen, then neighbours, then creditors; outsiders may purchase if none do.

Q35. What is the standard monthly interest rate on 100 panas?

- A) Half a pana
- B) One pana and a quarter
- C) Five panas
- D) Ten panas

Answer: B — The standard rate is one pana and a quarter per month on 100 panas.

Q36. After how many years are debts irrecoverable?

- A) Five years
- B) Seven years
- C) Ten years
- D) Twelve years

Answer: C — Debts not recognised for ten years are irrecoverable, with exceptions for minors, the elderly, the sick, etc.

Q37. What are the three forms of physical injury?

- A) Minor, moderate, severe
- B) Touching, menacing, striking
- C) Slapping, punching, kicking
- D) Verbal, physical, emotional

Answer: B — Physical injury is defined in three forms: touching, menacing (threatening), and striking.

Q38. What does Kautilya rank as the most serious single vice?

- A) Drinking
- B) Hunting
- C) Gambling
- D) Sexual indulgence

Answer: C — Gambling is ranked most serious as it generates conflict, enmity, and destabilises governance.

Q39. What are the seven constituents (Saptanga/Prakriti) of the state?

- A) Dharma, Artha, Kama, Moksha, Vidya, Shakti, Danda
- B) Svami, Amatya, Janapada, Durga, Kosha, Danda, Mitra
- C) King, Queen, Prince, Minister, General, Priest, People
- D) Army, Treasury, Fort, Land, Allies, Spies, Subjects

Answer: B — The seven constituents are Svami (king), Amatya (minister), Janapada (country), Durga (fort), Kosha (treasury), Danda (army), Mitra (ally).

Q40. Name the three types of enemies in the Mandala theory.

- A) Internal, external, potential
- B) Natural enemy, enemy by birth, made enemy
- C) Military, economic, political
- D) Hereditary, current, future

Answer: B — The three types are natural enemy (immediate proximity), enemy by birth (shared lineage), and made enemy (current circumstances).

Q41. How many kings and material constituents comprise the circle of kings?

- A) 10 kings, 50 constituents
- B) 12 kings, 60 constituents
- C) 15 kings, 75 constituents
- D) 20 kings, 100 constituents

Answer: B — The circle comprises twelve kings and sixty material constituents, totalling seventy-two positions.

Q42. What are the three kinds of Power (Shakti)?

- A) Political, economic, military
- B) Counsel (knowledge), might (resources), energy (valour)
- C) Physical, mental, spiritual
- D) Offensive, defensive, neutral

Answer: B — The three kinds are power of counsel, power of might, and power of energy.

Q43. Name the six measures (Gunas) of foreign policy.

- A) Alliance, trade, war, tribute, marriage, conquest
- B) Peace, war, staying quiet, marching, seeking shelter, dual policy
- C) Conciliation, gifts, dissension, force, neglect, punishment
- D) Attack, defence, retreat, diplomacy, siege, espionage

Answer: B — The six measures are peace (samdhi), war (vigraha), staying quiet (asana), marching (yana), seeking shelter (samshraya), and dual policy (dvaidhibhava).

Q44. When should a king make peace according to Kautilya?

- A) When prospering relative to the enemy
- B) When in decline relative to the enemy
- C) When the army is large
- D) When allies are strong

Answer: B — Make peace when in decline relative to an enemy; wage war when prospering.

Q45. When gains are equal under peace and war, which should the king choose?

- A) War, for strategic advantage
- B) Peace, to avoid costs and expenses of war
- C) Neither, stay quiet
- D) Dual policy

Answer: B — Peace is preferred because war carries additional costs of losses and expenses.

Q46. Between a strong unjust king and a weak just king, which should be attacked?

- A) The weak just king (easier target)
- B) Neither; seek peace
- C) The strong unjust king (subjects won't support him)
- D) Both simultaneously

Answer: C — Attack the strong unjust king because his subjects are unlikely to support him under duress.

Q47. What is the Dual Policy (Dvaidhibhava)?

- A) Fighting on two fronts simultaneously
- B) Peace with one while waging war against another
- C) Using both army and treasury
- D) Employing both spies and envoys

Answer: B — Dvaidhibhava means engaging in peace with one king while waging war against another.

Q48. What fraction of revenue is the state wage bill generally fixed at?

- A) One tenth
- B) One quarter
- C) One third
- D) One half

Answer: B — The wage bill is generally fixed at one quarter of the revenue.

Q49. What does Kautilya consider more dangerous: an internal revolt or an external one?

- A) An external revolt
- B) An internal revolt
- C) They are equally dangerous
- D) Neither is dangerous

Answer: B — An internal revolt is more dangerous; a revolt led by ministers is the gravest of all.

Q50. What four vices arise from lust?

- A) Greed, theft, fraud, corruption
- B) Hunting, gambling, sexual indulgence, drinking
- C) Laziness, gluttony, vanity, extravagance
- D) Pride, anger, jealousy, envy

Answer: B — Lust produces hunting, gambling, sexual indulgence, and drinking.

Q51. Name the six types of troops in order of preference.

- A) Hereditary, allied, hired, banded, alien, forest
- B) Hereditary, hired, banded, allied, alien, forest
- C) Royal, noble, mercenary, tribal, allied, volunteer
- D) Infantry, cavalry, chariots, elephants, archers, engineers

Answer: B — The order is hereditary, hired, banded, allied, alien, and forest troops.

Q52. Which season should the king march in to destroy monsoon crops?

- A) Chaitra
- B) Jyeshtha
- C) Margashirsha
- D) Ashvin

Answer: C — Margashirsha is for destroying monsoon crops; Chaitra for winter crops; Jyeshtha for grass and timber.

Q53. Why are Kshatriya troops considered most effective in warfare?

- A) They are most numerous
- B) They have the best weapons
- C) Their traditional warrior role makes them suited for combat
- D) They receive the highest pay

Answer: C — Kshatriya troops are typically the most effective given their traditional warrior role.

Q54. What are the standard features of a military camp?

- A) Two gates, three roads, four divisions
- B) Four gates, six roads, nine divisions, moat, rampart, parapet, towers
- C) Six gates, eight roads, twelve divisions
- D) One gate, two roads, six divisions

Answer: B — The camp has four gates, six roads, nine divisions, a moat, a rampart, a parapet, and towers.

Q55. What terrain is best suited to chariots?

- A) Mountains and forests
- B) Flat, firm, clear ground
- C) Marshy wetlands
- D) Uneven rocky terrain

Answer: B — Chariots suit flat, firm, clear ground without waterlogged areas.

Q56. What counter formation is used against the Falcon?

- A) Strengtheners

- B) Bow
- C) Staff
- D) Circle

Answer: B — The Bow counters the Falcon formation.

Q57. What is Kautilya's rule for dealing with a retreating defeated enemy?

- A) Pursue and destroy them completely
- B) Do not harass them; desperation makes them dangerous
- C) Offer them terms of surrender
- D) Let the ally handle the pursuit

Answer: B — Do not harass a defeated retreating enemy since their desperation can make them dangerous.

Q58. Why does Kautilya consider oligarchies (sanghas) valuable?

- A) They pay the highest taxes
- B) They are tightly knit and difficult for enemies to conquer
- C) They provide the best soldiers
- D) They control all trade routes

Answer: B — Oligarchies are tightly knit and become unassailable by enemies.

Q59. Name two types of oligarchies mentioned in the text.

- A) Religious and secular
- B) Economic/military (e.g., Kambojas) and kingship-based (e.g., Licchavikas)
- C) Urban and rural
- D) Trading and farming

Answer: B — Oligarchies are classified as economic/military (Kambojas, Surastras) and kingship-based (Licchavikas, Vrijikas, etc.).

Q60. What is the stated objective of Adhikarana 14 (Aupanishadikam)?

- A) To establish trade routes
- B) To protect the four varnas using secret practices against the unrighteous
- C) To train the army
- D) To collect taxes

Answer: B — The objective is to uphold social order by using covert tactics against unrighteous adversaries, protecting the four varnas.

Q61. What does Vartta comprise?

- A) Grammar, logic, philosophy
- B) Agriculture, cattle rearing, trade
- C) Astronomy, mathematics, medicine
- D) Music, dance, drama

Answer: B — Vartta comprises agriculture, cattle rearing, and trade—essential for prosperity.

Q62. What is Dandaniti concerned with?

- A) Religious ceremonies
- B) Diplomacy, law, punishment, military strategy

- C) Agricultural methods
- D) Trade regulations

Answer: B — Dandaniti concerns diplomacy, law, punishment, and military strategy.

Q63. What happens when Danda is applied too severely?

- A) The king earns respect
- B) The kingdom prospers
- C) It instils fear among subjects
- D) Subjects become loyal

Answer: C — Too severe application of Danda instils fear; too lenient leads to disrespect; just application earns respect.

Q64. Which king is cited as an example of destruction through pride?

- A) Ravana
- B) Aila
- C) Vatapi
- D) Janamejaya

Answer: A — Ravana exemplifies pride for not returning another man's wife.

Q65. What Kamasutra verse states Artha has eight meanings?

- A) 1.1.1
- B) 1.9.11
- C) 2.3.5
- D) 3.7.1

Answer: B — Kamasutra 1.9.11 lists eight meanings of Artha: land, cattle-wealth, gold, utensils, etc.

Q66. Who are the two deities saluted at the opening of the first Adhikarana?

- A) Vishnu and Shiva
- B) Brahma and Saraswati
- C) Shukra and Brihaspati
- D) Indra and Agni

Answer: C — The first Adhikarana opens with a salutation to Shukra and Brihaspati.

Q67. What is the Trayi?

- A) Three types of taxes
- B) The three Vedas: Rigveda, Yajurveda, Samaveda
- C) Three branches of philosophy
- D) Three levels of government

Answer: B — Trayi refers to the three Vedas: Rigveda, Samaveda, and Yajurveda.

Q68. What does Kautilya identify as the most serious calamity among the seven constituents?

- A) Calamity of the minister
- B) Calamity of the treasury
- C) Calamity of the king
- D) Calamity of the army

Answer: C — Kautilya holds the king's calamity as most serious since the king directs all action and can replace failing ministers.

Q69. According to Kautilya, which is more critical: the treasury or the army?

- A) The army
- B) The treasury
- C) They are equal
- D) Depends on the situation

Answer: B — The treasury underpins the army's strength, making it more critical.

Q70. What are the duties of a Vaishya according to the text?

- A) Only trade and commerce
- B) Studying, sacrifices, gifts, agriculture, cattle rearing, and trade
- C) Military service and governance
- D) Teaching and performing rituals

Answer: B — Vaishya duties include studying, performing sacrifices, making gifts, and engaging in agriculture, cattle rearing, and trade.

Q71. Who evaluates a minister candidate's intelligence, perseverance, and dexterity?

- A) The king personally
- B) Through their kin
- C) Through past projects
- D) Through secret tests

Answer: C — Intelligence, perseverance, and dexterity are evaluated through past projects.

Q72. What is a Tikshna spy?

- A) A religious spy
- B) A farmer-spy
- C) An extremely valorous and brave spy
- D) A jobless but pure-hearted spy

Answer: C — Tikshna is a Sanchari spy type described as extremely valorous and brave.

Q73. What is the fine for loss of a lawsuit?

- A) One tenth of the dispute amount
- B) One fifth of the dispute amount
- C) One half of the dispute amount
- D) The entire dispute amount

Answer: B — The fine is one fifth of the dispute amount for loss of suit; one tenth for voluntary admission.

Q74. Up to what generation do descendants receive equal shares of unpartitioned paternal property?

- A) Second generation
- B) Third generation
- C) Fourth generation
- D) Fifth generation

Answer: C — Sons and grandsons up to the fourth generation receive equal shares.

Q75. What interest rate applies to forest travel loans?

- A) Five panas
- B) Ten panas
- C) Fifteen panas
- D) Twenty panas

Answer: B — The rate for forest travel is ten panas per month on 100 panas.

Q76. Up to what point may marriage be revoked for the upper three varnas?

- A) Up to betrothal
- B) Up to the hand-clasping ceremony
- C) Up to consummation
- D) Marriage cannot be revoked

Answer: B — For upper three varnas, revocation is possible up to the hand-clasping ceremony; for Shudras, up to consummation.

Q77. What is the Udasina (neutral king)?

- A) A king at war with everyone
- B) A king positioned beyond the influence of conqueror, enemy, and middle king
- C) A king with no army
- D) A king who has surrendered

Answer: B — The neutral king is beyond the influence of conqueror, enemy, and middle king, and is stronger than surrounding constituents.

Q78. What trade routes does Kautilya prefer: land or water?

- A) Water routes for speed
- B) Land routes for reliability and accessibility
- C) Both equally
- D) Neither; he prefers no trade

Answer: B — Land routes are preferred over water routes as more reliable and accessible.

Q79. Which Adhikarana deals with the 'Circle of Kings'?

- A) Adhikarana 5
- B) Adhikarana 6
- C) Adhikarana 7
- D) Adhikarana 8

Answer: B — Adhikarana 6, Mandalayonih, deals with the Circle of Kings.

Q80. What is the meaning of 'Kantakashodhanam'?

- A) Circle of Kings
- B) Suppression of criminals
- C) Concerning calamities
- D) Secret practices

Answer: B — Kantakashodhanam (Adhikarana 4) means suppression of criminals.

Q81. What is 'Vyasanadhikarikam'?

- A) Concerning trade

- B) Concerning calamities (Adhikarana 8)
- C) Concerning warfare
- D) Concerning taxation

Answer: B — Vyasanadhikarikam (Adhikarana 8) means Concerning Calamities.

Q82. What is 'Abhiyasyatkarma'?

- A) Secret practices
- B) Methods of science
- C) Activities of a king about to march (Adhikarana 9)
- D) Policy toward oligarchies

Answer: C — Abhiyasyatkarma (Adhikarana 9) means Activities of a King About to March.

Q83. What is 'Sangramikam'?

- A) Concerning festivals
- B) Concerning wars (Adhikarana 10)
- C) Concerning the treasury
- D) Concerning agriculture

Answer: B — Sangramikam (Adhikarana 10) means Concerning Wars.

Q84. What does 'Abaliyasam' deal with?

- A) The stronger king
- B) The weaker king (Adhikarana 12)
- C) Trade routes
- D) Military camps

Answer: B — Abaliyasam (Adhikarana 12) concerns the weaker king.

Q85. What is a Parvan day?

- A) A day of war
- B) An auspicious day for worship and offerings
- C) A market day
- D) A day of rest

Answer: B — Parvan days are auspicious days on which specific worship and offerings are prescribed as remedial measures.

Q86. On whom does the king first enforce the system of punishment?

- A) Common citizens
- B) Military officers
- C) Officers who handle monetary matters
- D) Foreign traders

Answer: C — The king enforces punishment first on officers handling monetary matters so they learn corrective measures.

Q87. What punishment applies for breaking into the royal treasury?

- A) Simple death
- B) Exile
- C) Death by torture

D) Fine of 1000 panas

Answer: C — For breaking into treasuries, death by torture is mandated.

Q88. What is the fine for the first offence of a pickpocket at a holy site?

- A) Twenty four panas
- B) Fifty four panas
- C) One hundred panas
- D) Six hundred panas

Answer: B — First-time pickpockets at holy sites face cutting of fingers or a fine of fifty-four panas; repeat offences lead to death.

Q89. What is a Goruta?

- A) A unit of weight
- B) A unit of area used for the king's recreational park
- C) A type of fortress
- D) A military formation

Answer: B — Goruta is a unit of area; the king's recreational animal park is one goruta in size.

Q90. What array is used for marching through a narrow path?

- A) Circle array
- B) Staff array
- C) Needle array
- D) Snake array

Answer: C — The needle array is used for narrow paths.

Q91. Where do the king and women march during an expedition?

- A) At the front
- B) In the centre
- C) In the rear
- D) On the flanks

Answer: B — The king and the women march in the centre of the formation.

Q92. What method is used to test the purity of gold and silver?

- A) Weighing
- B) Heating and cooling
- C) Touchstone
- D) Visual inspection only

Answer: C — Purity is assessed using a touchstone, with methods to recognise genuine materials based on streak and smoothness.

Q93. What is the Adhikarana dealing with judiciary?

- A) Adhikarana 2
- B) Adhikarana 3 (Dharmasthiyam)
- C) Adhikarana 4
- D) Adhikarana 5

Answer: B — Adhikarana 3, Dharmasthiyam, concerns judiciary.

Q94. What duty rate applies to metals, spices, and textiles?

- A) One fifth
- B) One sixth
- C) One tenth or one fifteenth
- D) One twentieth

Answer: C — One tenth or one fifteenth duty applies to metals, spices, and textiles.

Q95. What are wedding gifts and items for religious ceremonies exempt from?

- A) All taxes
- B) Custom duty
- C) Income tax
- D) Nothing; they are taxed

Answer: B — Wedding gifts and items for religious ceremonies are duty free.

Q96. What is a 'Pana'?

- A) A unit of weight
- B) A monetary unit for reckoning fines and fees
- C) A unit of distance
- D) A measure of grain

Answer: B — Pana is the monetary unit in which fines and fees are reckoned throughout the Arthashastra.

Q97. Which Panchanga calculations originate from Arthashastra 2.20?

- A) Revenue calculations
- B) Temporal (time) calculations
- C) Military calculations
- D) Agricultural calculations

Answer: B — The temporal calculations of Arthashastra 2.20 remain in use in the traditional Indian almanac (panchanga).

Q98. What is 'Niyoga' in the Tantrayukti scheme?

- A) An option between alternatives
- B) Restriction: 'thus and in no other way'
- C) A combination of methods
- D) An analogy

Answer: B — Niyoga means restriction: 'thus and in no other way.'

Q99. What is 'Vikalpa' in the Tantrayukti scheme?

- A) Restriction
- B) Option: 'either in this way or in that'
- C) Combination
- D) Exception

Answer: B — Vikalpa means option: 'either in this way or in that.'

Q100. What is the ruling about a small rear disturbance vs a large front gain?

- A) Front gain is more important

- B) A small rear disturbance is more critical
- C) They are equally important
- D) Neither matters

Answer: B — A small disturbance in the rear is more critical than a substantial gain in front; if ignored, it grows worse.